

词汇: *history* 历史

- 1 Stand outside Chancery Lane Tube station in London and you'll probably notice the regular commuters, trendy cafes and the odd tourist. Look up and you'll see the Staple Inn, built in 1585, and one of the last remaining **Tudor timber-framed facades** in London. But deep below your feet, there's more history lurking.
- 2 **Nestled** between Fournival Street and Fulwood Place in this area of London are a **network** of **tunnels** even deeper than **The London Underground**. Built between 1940 and 1942, the tunnels were constructed as part of the war effort as an **air-raid shelter**, designed to protect civilians and soldiers from bombs dropped in the war. Later in World War Two, the tunnels were occupied by Special Operations Executive and are even believed to have been the inspiration behind Q branch in the James Bond novels. The tunnels are set to open to the public in the near future.
- 3 Somewhere that can never open to the public is a secret Victorian street in Bristol. Now considered too dangerous to enter, a local historian climbed down to the street in 1999. He hoped to find **gas street lamps**, **sash window frames** and Victorian **fire grates frozen in time**. Instead, he found thieves had stripped the street, and it was mostly full of rubbish, though some **bricked-up** shop windows remained. The row of shops was buried in 1879 when a railway was built, and the company raised the road level.
- 4 In Scotland, there is an even older piece of history under foot. Mary King's Close in the centre of Edinburgh is a hidden network of **preserved** streets and homes from the 1600s. Down under the Royal Mile, the **alleyways** were once **bustling** and open-air but also dark and rather smelly. Many Old Town Edinburgh streets in the 1600s consisted of high-**tenement** buildings where the rich occupied the top stories and the poor lived on the ground floors, which were often flooded with **sewage**. The streets on Mary King's Close were built over in the 1750s and only re-discovered in 2003 during an archaeological investigation. It's now a tourist attraction, so you can go down and see the streets for yourself.
- 5 So, when you're out and about in the city, admire what's above ground, but also consider the history that could be hiding beneath your feet.

测验与练习

一、为本文选择总结句。

- a. The oldest underground streets are in the UK
- b. There are four secret underground streets in the UK
- c. Some UK hidden underground locations are now open to the public

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. Where are the London tunnels that were used as an air-raid shelter in World War Two?

- a. Opposite the Staple Inn
- b. Inside Chancery Lane tube station
- c. Between Fournival Street and Fulwood Place

2. The tunnels inspired...

- a. a writer.
- b. a spy.
- c. politicians.

3. A local historian in Bristol found an underground street full of Victorian artefacts.

- a. True
- b. False
- c. Not given

4. Why are the alleyways under the Royal Mile described as 'rather smelly'?

- a. Because the poor lived on the ground floors.
- b. Because the ground floors were often covered with sewage.
- c. Because so many people lived in the tenements.

5. Why was Mary King's Close hidden for so many years?

- a. Because it was being made into a tourist attraction.
- b. Because buildings were constructed over it.
- c. Because it was only open to archaeologists.

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

Beneath our city streets sometimes sit **1)** _____ of old passageways, hidden from view and forgotten about. There are some **2)** _____ in London that were once used as **3)** _____. It's not common to find places like this **4)** _____. In Bristol, an underground lane of shops was discovered only to be full of mostly rubbish and **5)** _____ windows.

tunnels	frozen in time	air-raid shelters
bricked-up		occupied
networks		nestled

（答案见词汇表后）

词汇表

Tudor	都铎世代的
timber-framed	木框架结构的
facade	(建筑物的) 正面
nestle	位于, 坐落于
network	网络
tunnel	隧道
The London Underground	伦敦地铁
air-raid shelter	防空洞
gas street lamp	煤气街灯
sash window frame	上下拉的窗框
fire grate	火炉栅
frozen in time	定格在时间中, 经久未变
bricked-up	用砖堵上的
preserved	被留存下来的
alleyway	小巷, 窄街
bustling	熙熙攘攘的, 热闹的
tenement	公寓楼
sewage	污水

答案

一、为本文选择总结句。

c. The tunnels are *set to open to the public* in the near future. and It's now *a tourist attraction* so you can go down and see the streets for yourself.

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. **c. *Nestled between Fournival Street and Fulwood Place* in this area of London are *a network of tunnels* even deeper than The London Underground.**

2. **a. ...and are even believed to have been *the inspiration behind Q branch* in the James Bond *novels*.**

3. **b. False. He *hoped to find* gas street lamps, sash window frames and Victorian fire grates frozen in time. *Instead he found thieves had stripped the street* and it was mostly *full of rubbish*, though some bricked-up shop windows remained.**

4. **b. Many Old Town Edinburgh streets in the 1600s consisted of high-tenement buildings where the rich occupied the top stories and the poor lived on *the ground floors, which were often flooded with sewage*.**

5. **b. The *streets* on Mary King's Close *were built over* in the 1750s and only re-discovered in 2003 during an archaeological investigation.**

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

Beneath our city streets sometimes sit **networks** of old passageways, hidden from view and forgotten about. There are some **tunnels** in London that were once used as **air-raid shelters**. It's not common to find places like this **frozen in time**. In Bristol, an underground lane of shops was discovered only to be full of mostly rubbish and **bricked-up** windows.